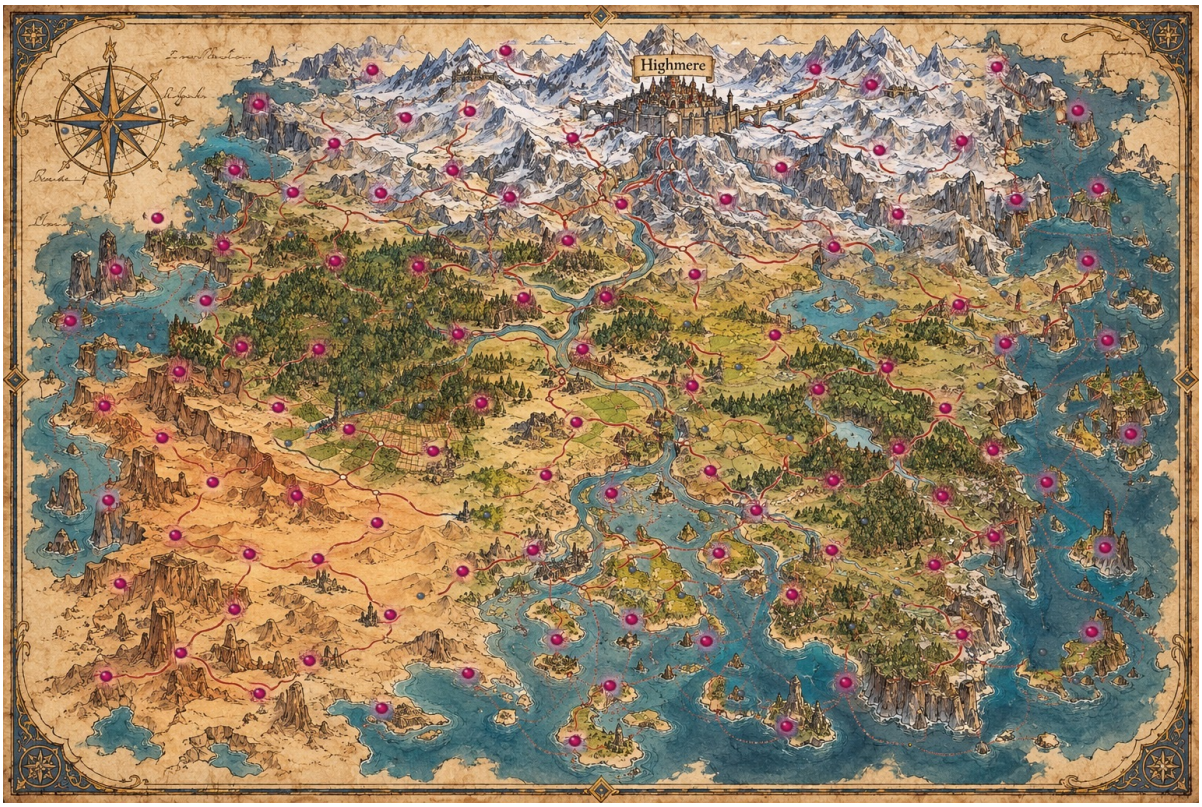
Four Roads

Volume One



The Great Map in the palace of Highmere. Each place has a stone; this winter all one hundred are glowing.

To the young problem-solvers of the club,

I am Orla, Regent of Highmere. In the highest room of my palace hangs the Great Map. Beside every town, harbor and mountain pass sits a stone with a twin in that very place. When something goes wrong there, the stone on my map glows. It glows, but it cannot tell me what happened.

This winter, every stone is glowing.

So four young people have set out on four roads: Mira, a forest ranger; Tavi, the court mage's apprentice; Suri, a ledger clerk; and Bao, who rows the mail boat. At each place they must find out what really happened, and help put it right. The first answer is not always the true one, and the map is not always right.

Will you travel with them?

Orla

Read an adventure. Stop. Try the idea yourself.

FOR READERS AND PARENTS

A journey told in words, pictures and puzzles

What is the book?

One long story in twenty-five chapters. In each place the travelers meet people, animals and trouble, and they use mathematics, logic and science to understand what is going on: a bridge that is slower than it looks, a float carried by two layers of a river, a wheel that will not run true, tree rings that tell a date. Pictures carry the story; diagrams give the facts; letters, notices and diaries in the characters' own hands hide clues of their own.

Who is it for?

Readers aged 10 and up, roughly Grades 5 to 9, and stronger students who like a real challenge. Each main puzzle is marked ★ easy, ★★ medium or ★★★ hard. The science each puzzle needs is explained in a sentence or two where it is used. No calculus, no tricks: every answer can be explained in plain words.

What is in each chapter?

The story, the main puzzle with a lantern hint, the full solution in the chapter (so a reader can check, or simply read on), and two exercises with their answers printed upside down.

English or Vietnamese

The book exists in both languages: the same stories, pictures, maps and puzzles. Brothers, sisters and friends can read different editions and still talk about the same places.

How is it given?

Volume One is a gift from Math Club & Competitions to the club's award winners.

Try it. The sample has the foreword, the prologue and the first four chapters, one for each traveler.



1. Medicine Across the Bridge ★
Mira



2. Mail in Midstream ★★
Bao



3. Fitting Spokes to the Rim ★★★
Tavi



4. One Ring Each Year ★
Suri